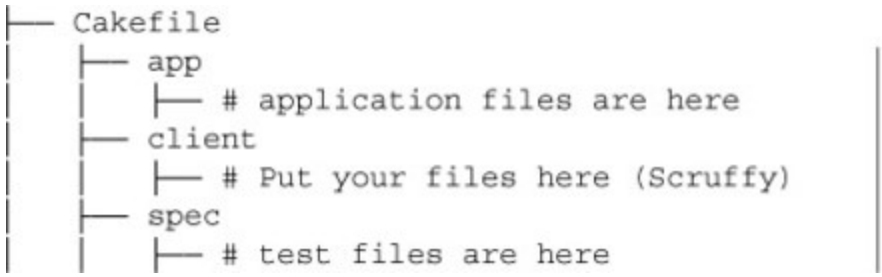
Now it’s time to look at how the modules and builds you’ve gotten used to can be applied to those parts of your application that run on the client. It’s time for the client side. After all, it’s quite likely that the client side is the majority of your application.

12.3. Client-side modules (in a web browser)

Imagine now that Agtron wants to add comments to his blog and have them updated and visible immediately without users having to refresh the page. To achieve this you’ll need part of the application to run on the client. This is commonly referred to as a *thick client*.

Scruffy has board meetings all day for the rest of the week but agrees to modify the server-side application so that it will serve up all the data for the comments as JSON and also to modify the application to serve the JavaScript files that will be your client-side application. *You don’t have to worry about how Scruffy is going to achieve that*. Later that day you receive an email from Scruffy telling you to put the client-side scripts into the app folder:



Put the client and spec directories in the same directory as the app directory.

When you move the application to run on the client in a web browser, how will you organize it into modules? Web browsers don’t understand modules. Two options come to mind:

- Return to the dark ages and just develop your entire application in a single file.
- Find a way to get modules to work on the client.